

New Business Entity Setup Checklist

LLC/Corp Formation Guide (Oregon + Nationwide)

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Setting up a business entity correctly from the start prevents costly problems later. This step-by-step guide covers the key actions for forming an LLC or Corporation, with Oregon-specific details and nationwide notes.

Step 1: Choose Your Entity Type

- ☐ Research entity types: Sole Proprietorship, LLC, S-Corp, C-Corp, Partnership
- ☐ Consult with an attorney or CPA on tax implications of each structure
 - ☐ Consider liability protection, tax treatment, and ownership flexibility
 - ☐ Decide on single-member vs. multi-member (LLC) or stock structure (Corp)

Step 2: Name Your Business

- ☐ Search Oregon Secretary of State business name database
- ☐ Check federal trademark database (USPTO TESS)
- ☐ Verify domain name availability
- ☐ Reserve your business name (Oregon: \$100 online)
- ☐ File a DBA/Assumed Business Name if using a trade name

Step 3: File Formation Documents

- ☐ Oregon LLC: File Articles of Organization with Secretary of State (\$100)
- ☐ Oregon Corp: File Articles of Incorporation (\$100)
- ☐ Designate a Registered Agent in Oregon
- ☐ Other states: File in your state of organization + foreign registration

Step 4: Get Your EIN & Tax Setup

- ☐ Apply for EIN (Employer Identification Number) at IRS.gov — 1
- ☐ Register with Oregon Department of Revenue
 - ☐ Register for Oregon Combined Payroll Tax if hiring employees
 - ☐ Determine sales tax obligations (Oregon has no sales tax)
 - ☐ Elect S-Corp tax status with IRS if desired (Form 966)

Step 5: Business Operations Setup

- ☐ Open a dedicated business bank account
- ☐ Get a business credit card
- ☐ Set up accounting software (QuickBooks Online recommended)
- ☐ Purchase business insurance (general liability, professional liability)
- ☐ Draft Operating Agreement (LLC) or Bylaws (Corp)
- ☐ Obtain necessary business licenses and permits

Step 6: Ongoing Compliance

- ☐ Oregon Annual Report filing (\$100, due on anniversary of formation)
- ☐ Maintain registered agent and keep address current
- ☐ File annual tax returns (federal and state)
- ☐ Keep corporate records and meeting minutes
- ☐ Renew business licenses as required

Ready to Get Started?

Schedule a free discovery call at blueprintsandbookkeeping.com/schedule or email tea@blueprintsandbookkeeping.com

